Manual 6: The exception desk and its paper

For whoever sits at the far end of the marquee

The exception desk is where a runner without a code is found, and where a strip of paper is torn off and handed over. First the paper you need; then, exception by exception, what to do with it.

What the exception desk is for

Everything at the goody bag table runs on two scans: the runner's code, then the bag. The exception desk is where everybody comes who cannot do the first scan - a flat phone, a letter that never arrived, no email address, a friend collecting, a child on their own. The desk does not hand over bags. It finds the person in the list and hands over **paper**; the table does the rest (Manual 5).

> ***The desk tears a slip off the only sheet it is on, and logs the tear. The gap in the sheet is the record of what the desk gave away.***

Part A: The paper you need

A1. The list

Print these the evening before, from the *output* folder. The easy desk's Import and start, or the race desk's buttons, make all of them.

print	file in output/	copies	where it goes
Goody bag labels	labels_*.pdf	one per bag	on each bag
Block maps	block_map_*.pdf	one per class	taped to the table legs
Collection lists	collection_list_*.pdf	one per table	on the goody bag tables, and one here
Tear-off slip sheets	slips_LTR_*.pdf (one per class) and slips_across_classes.pdf	one set only	here, in a folder, one sheet set per class
Exception desk sheet	exception_desk.pdf	one	here: five parts, see A2
Printed invitations	invites_*.pdf, for the registrations in part 5 of the exception desk sheet	as needed	here, filed by surname
The two app codes	open_scanner_qr.png, open_leftover_qr.png	one each	taped to the goody bag table
Rehearsal pack	rehearsal/rehearsal_pack.pdf	one per volunteer pair	training, before race day only

> ***Print the slip sheets once. A slip that could be reprinted from two places would authorise twice.***

A2. The exception desk sheet, part by part

exception_desk.pdf is made every time the export is slimmed. Each part starts on its own page.

Part 1: delegate slips. A slip already printed for each registration whose family chose someone outside it to collect (option 3). Cut them apart and file them under the **collector's** surname. These registrations are not on the class slip sheets.

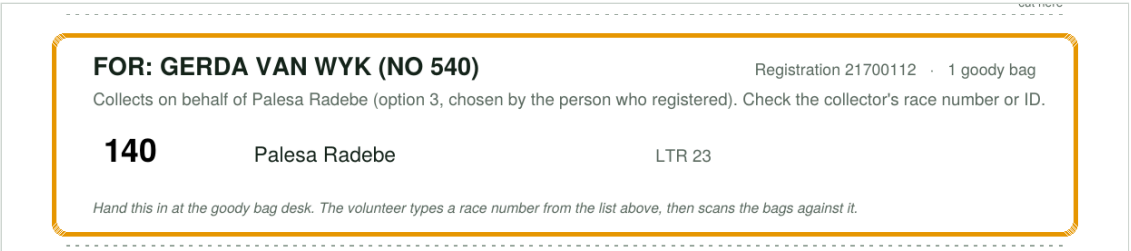


Figure 1. *Part 1, one slip. FOR: the collector and their race number. Below: the bag, with the race number the table will type.*

Part 2: the choices. Every registration that changed the standard rule, and what it means at the table.

REGISTERED BY	REGISTRATION	OPT	AT THE TABLE	RACE NUMBERS
Palesa Radebe	21700112	3	Gerda van Wyk (No 540) collects with the slip in part 1	140
Werner Botha	21700900	1	Ruben Kruger (13) may collect for the group	512 1016 1017

Figure 2. *Part 2, one line: the Krugers chose option 1, so Ruben (13) may collect for the family.*

Part 3: codes that do not collect. Everyone whose own code the scanner refuses, and who collects instead.

2 entrant(s). The scanner shows their name in amber and opens nothing. Send them back to the person named, or issue a slip here if that person agrees.

SURNAME, NAME	NO	AGE	CLASS	WHY	COLLECTS INSTEAD
Kruger, Ruan	1016	12	LTR 5	under 16	Werner Botha
Mthembu, Pieter	1021	15	LTR 5	under 16	Anna Mthembu

Figure 3. *Part 3, one line: Ruan Kruger is 12. His own code opens nothing; Werner Botha collects.*

Part 4: replies still to sort. Replies to the collection letter that were too unclear or too late to apply. Families may arrive expecting a change.

2 reply(ies) the reader could not read clearly and nobody has entered by hand. Until they are sorted, those registrations follow the standard rule. If the family turns up expecting a change, settle it here.

FROM	RECEIVED	REGISTRATION	WHY IT WAS LEFT
lerato@example.com	2026-10-05 12:05	21700104	option 3, but no race number or name of another entrant found
marius@example.com	2026-10-08 08:15	21700113	arrived Thu 08 Oct 08:15, after the reply deadline

Figure 4. *Part 4, one line, with the reason it was left.*

Part 5: no email address. First the registrations with no address at all - nobody was sent a letter or a code - then those on somebody else's letter, with whose.

1 entrant(s) on registrations with no email address at all: nobody was sent a letter or a code. Print their invitation, or give them a slip from the class sheet when they come to this desk.

SURNAME, NAME	NO	CLASS	REGISTRATION	WHAT TO DO
Steyn, Mevrou	547	LTR 10	21700118	no letter: printed invitation, or a slip

2 entrant(s) with no address of their own, on somebody else's letter. Their bag is released by that letter's code, so send them to whoever it went to.

SURNAME, NAME	NO	CLASS	ON THE LETTER OF
Kruger, Ruben	1017	LTR 5	Werner Botha (kruger.family@example.com)

Figure 5. *Part 5. Mevrou Steyn had no letter; Ruben Kruger and Pieter Mthembu are on someone else's.*

A3. The slip sheets

One sheet set per class, plus one for the families whose race numbers are spread across classes. Each slip: the surname in bold, then one line per bag. Every registration is on exactly one sheet.

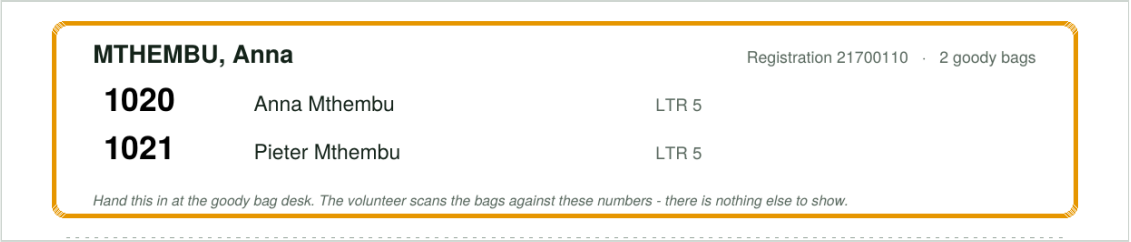


Figure 6. *A family in one class: on that class's sheet.*

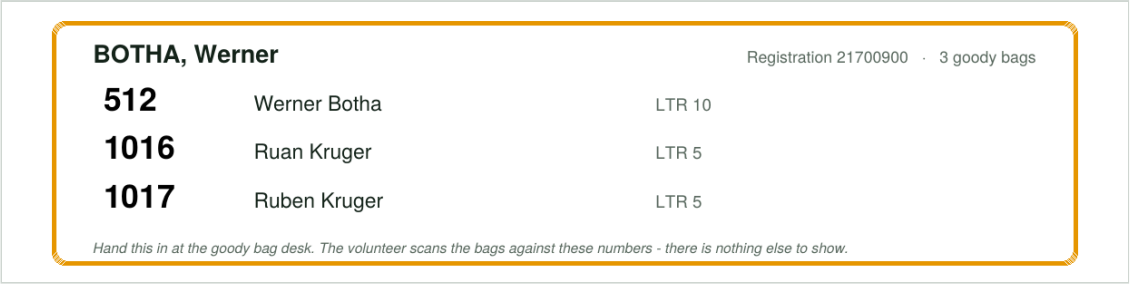


Figure 7. *A family across two classes: on slips_across_classes.pdf, not on either class sheet.*

A4. The page on the PC

The exception desk has one page of its own: */exception* on the server's address. Open it on the registration PC itself. A second laptop on the same Wi-Fi can find slips too, but only logs a tear if the server was started with a desk PIN (*--desk-pin*), which it asks for once.

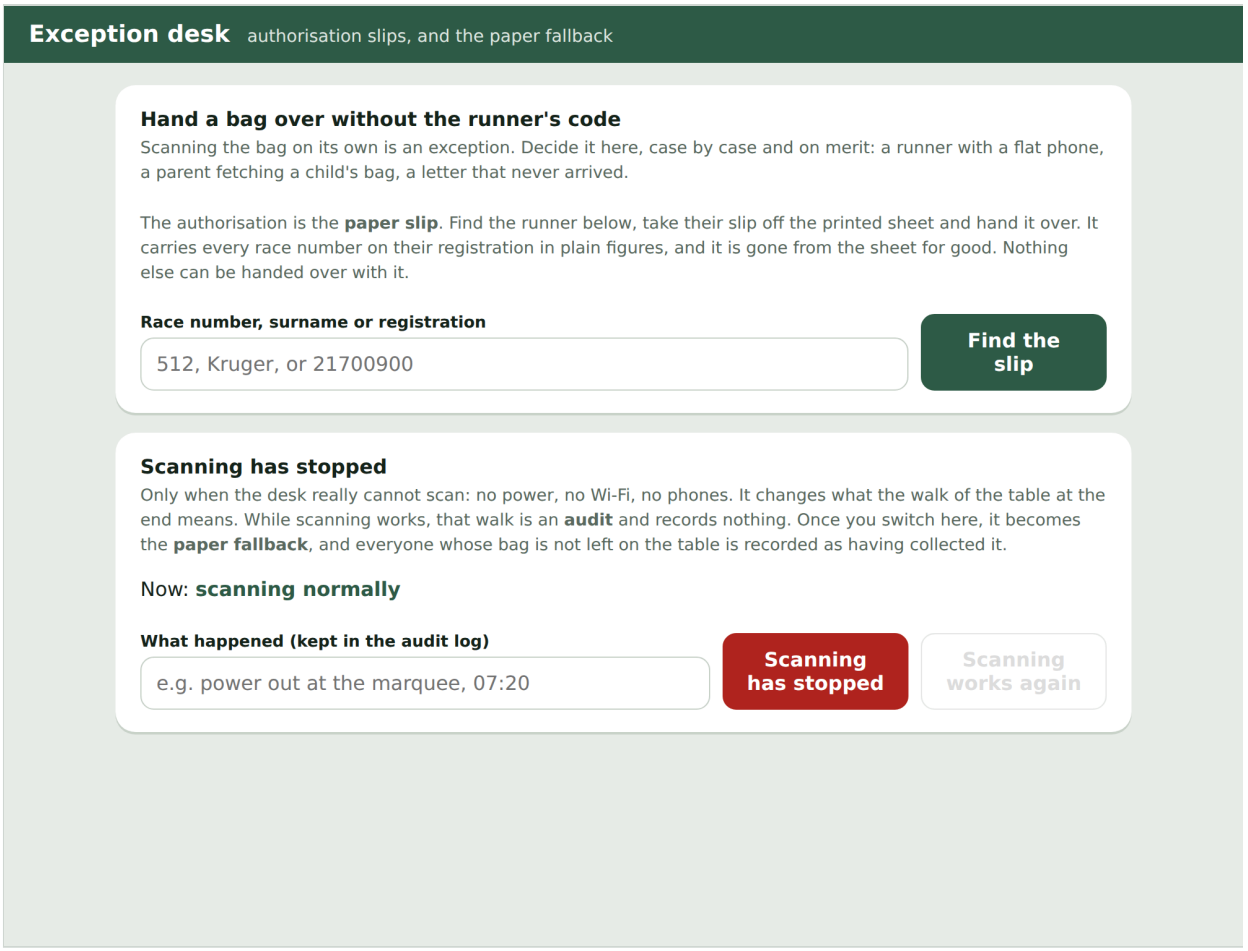


Figure 8. *The whole exception desk. It answers one question: whose slip, on which sheet.*

Part B: Procedures

Each procedure starts with who is in front of you.

B1. A runner with no code: flat phone, deleted email, no letter

1. Ask for their race number, or their surname.
2. Type it into **Race number, surname or registration** and press **Find the slip**.
3. Read what the page says: the names, the bags, who registered, any choice, any code that does not collect, and **which printed sheet** the slip is on.
4. Check the person in front of you is on that registration, or the person who registered it, or an adult on it.
5. Find the slip on that sheet. Tear it off.
6. Press **Slip torn off and handed over**. The tear goes into the audit log with the time.
7. Hand them the slip and send them to the goody bag table.

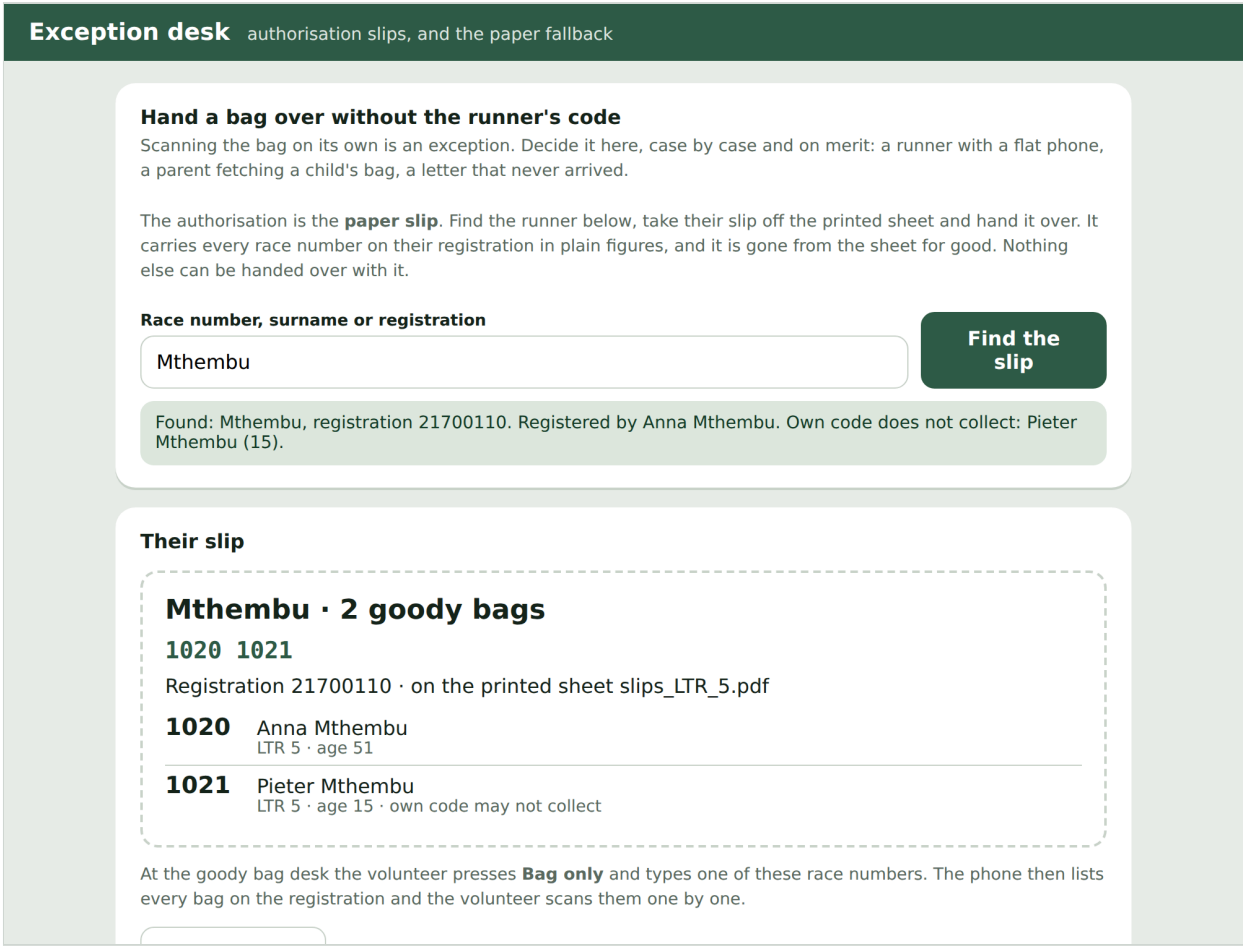


Figure 9. *Found by surname: two bags, both numbers, the sheet the slip is on, who registered, and that Pieter (15) cannot collect on his own code.*

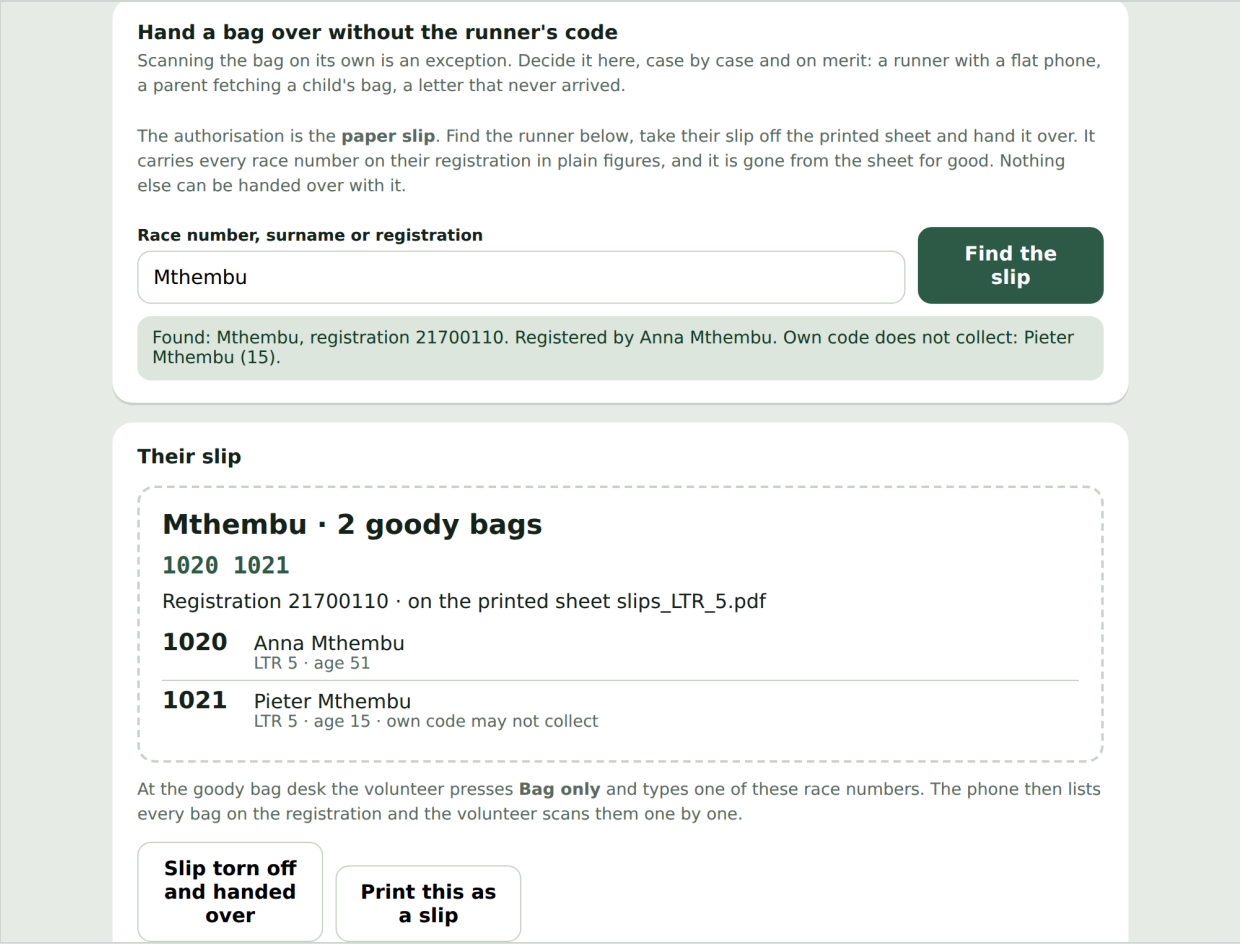


Figure 10. *Logged. The record can now tell a bag handed over on the desk's authority from one that was not.*

For a family across classes, the page says the slip is on *slips_across_classes.pdf*:

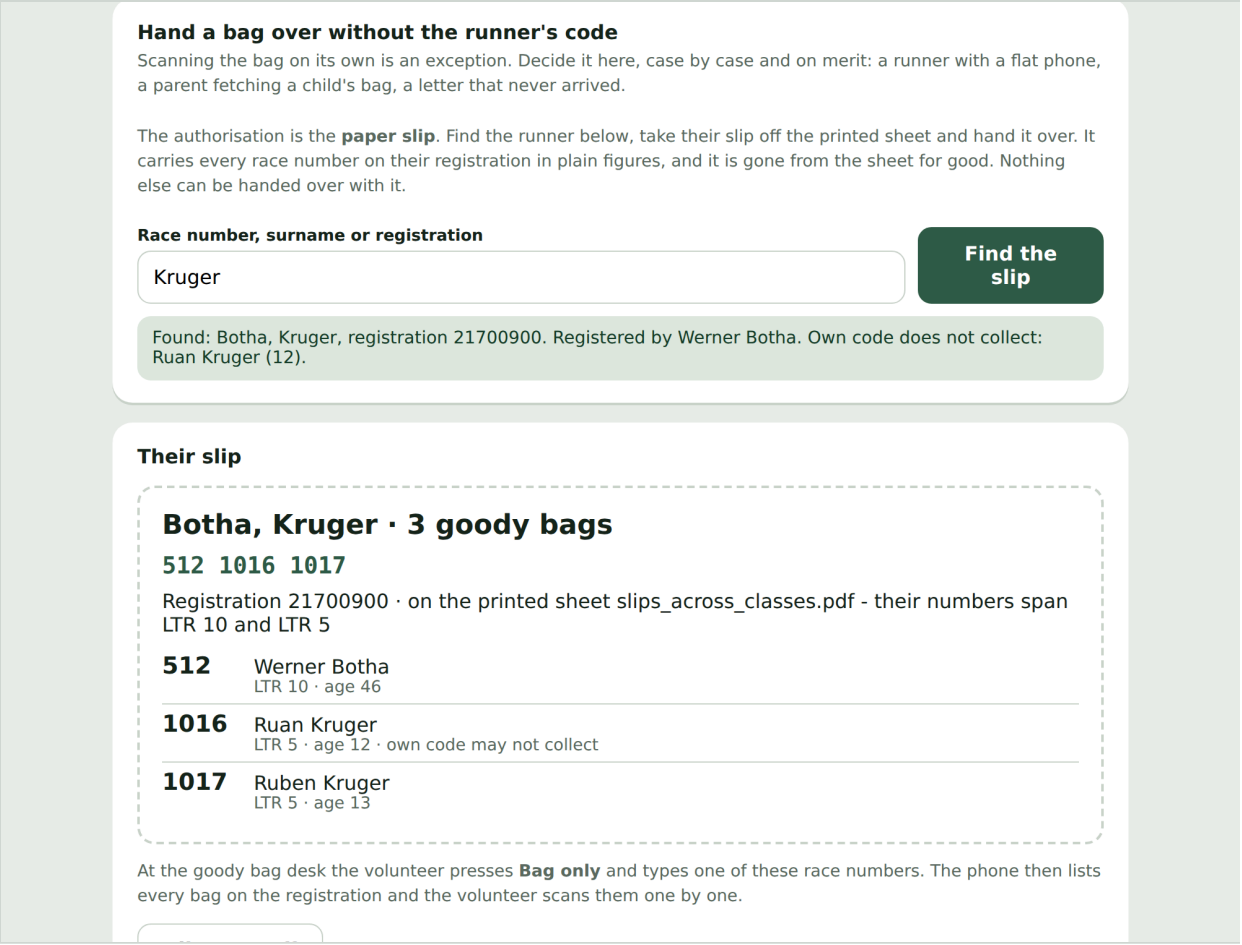


Figure 11. *The Krugers: two classes, so neither class sheet. The page also says Ruan's code will not collect and Ruben's will.*

B2. Nobody in the family had an email address

They are in part 5 of the exception desk sheet, first table (A2). If their invitation was printed, hand it over: it carries their code and the table scans it like a phone. If not, follow B1 and hand over their slip.

B3. A friend collecting for someone (option 3)

1. Ask whom they are collecting for. Type that person's surname and press **Find the slip**.
2. The page names the collector the family chose, and says the slip is on the exception desk sheet under the collector's name.
3. Check the person in front of you is that collector: their race number or ID.
4. Take their pre-printed slip from part 1, press **Slip torn off and handed over**, and hand it over.

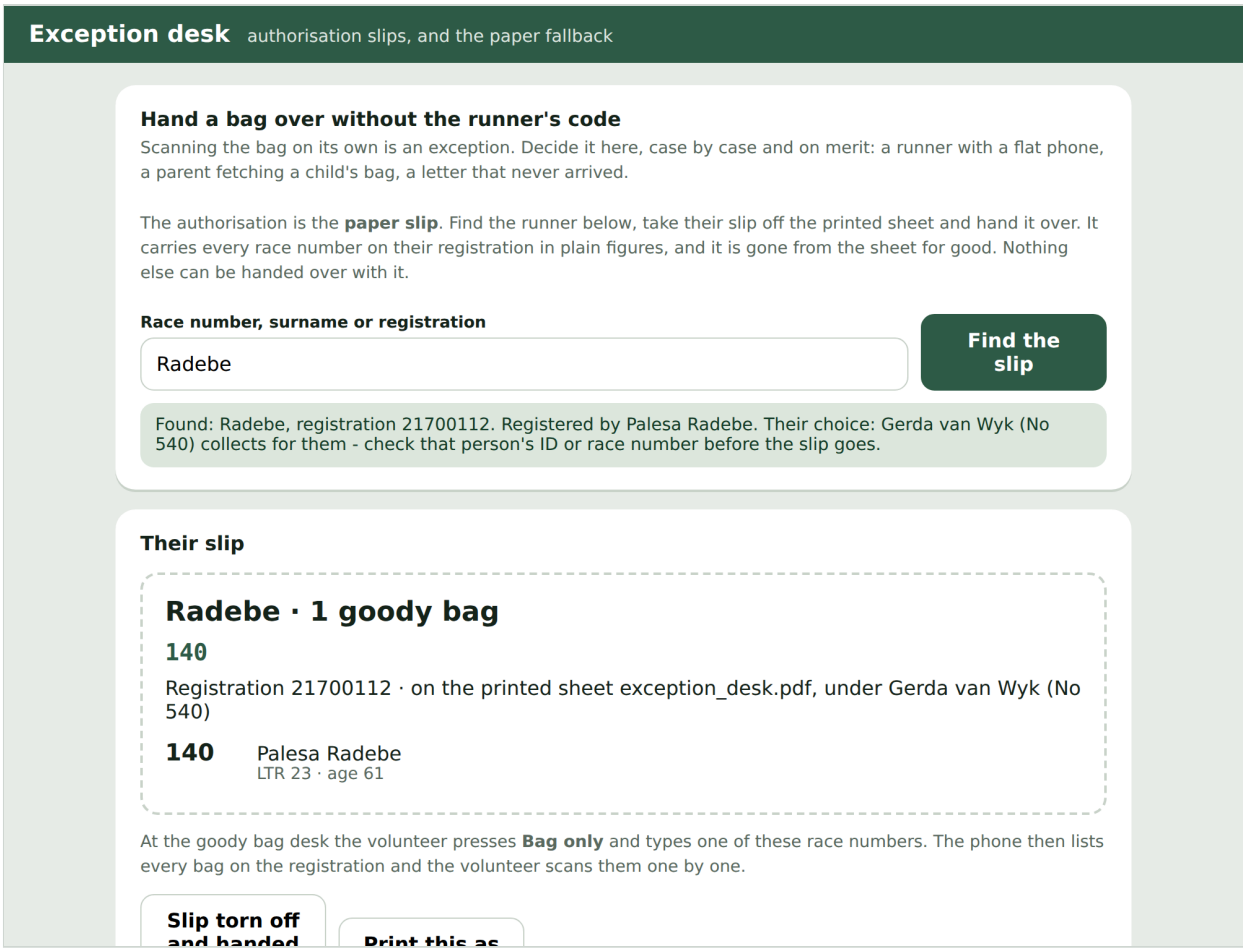


Figure 12. *Palesa Radebe's registration: her choice, Gerda van Wyk (No 540), and where the slip is.*

The collector collects their own bag separately, with their own code.

B4. A child under 16 on their own, or a code that was refused

The table sent them because their code "may not collect".

1. Find them by surname. Part 3 of the sheet, and the page, say who collects instead.
2. Tell them. The usual answer is to fetch that person, or an adult on the registration.
3. Only if that person agrees - in person, or on the phone - follow B1 and give the family's slip to whoever they name. Write that on the slip.

B5. A family wants a change on the day

Their reply was late or unclear (part 4), or they never replied. The standard rule applies to them. If they want something else - a friend to collect, a child to collect - settle it here: follow B1 and give the family's slip to the person the registrant names, and write it on the slip.

B6. Someone on somebody else's letter

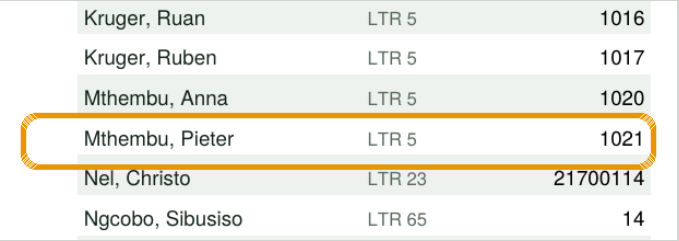
Part 5, second table, says whose letter covers them. Send them to that person, whose code opens every bag on the registration. If that person is not here, follow B1.

B7. No race number yet

They are named by alert 14 and in part 5 if they have no address. They have no bag on the table. Send them to the late entry and compliance desk; nothing is handed over until that desk gives them a number.

B8. Finding a bag that has wandered

Use the collection list: surname, class, race number. The race number is the position on the table.



Kruger, Ruan	LTR 5	1016
Kruger, Ruben	LTR 5	1017
Mthembu, Anna	LTR 5	1020
Mthembu, Pieter	LTR 5	1021
Nel, Christo	LTR 23	21700114
Ngcobo, Sibusiso	LTR 65	14

Figure 13. *The collection list, one line. The number is where the bag lives.*

Part C: When scanning stops

Only the desk decides that scanning has stopped - not a volunteer with a phone.

1. Type what happened in **What happened** and press **Scanning has stopped**.
2. The table-walk app on the phones turns red: the walk of the table now becomes the record.
3. Carry on handing over against the printed collection lists, ticking names.
4. When scanning works again, press **Scanning works again**.

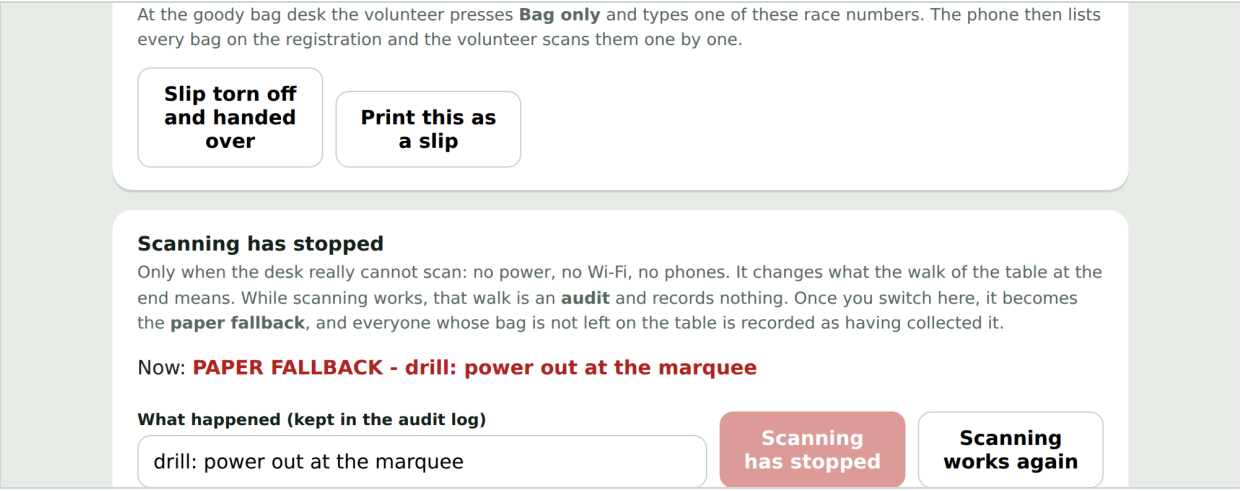


Figure 14. *The one switch that changes what a later action means. It needs a reason, the reason goes in the audit log, and only the desk can press it.*

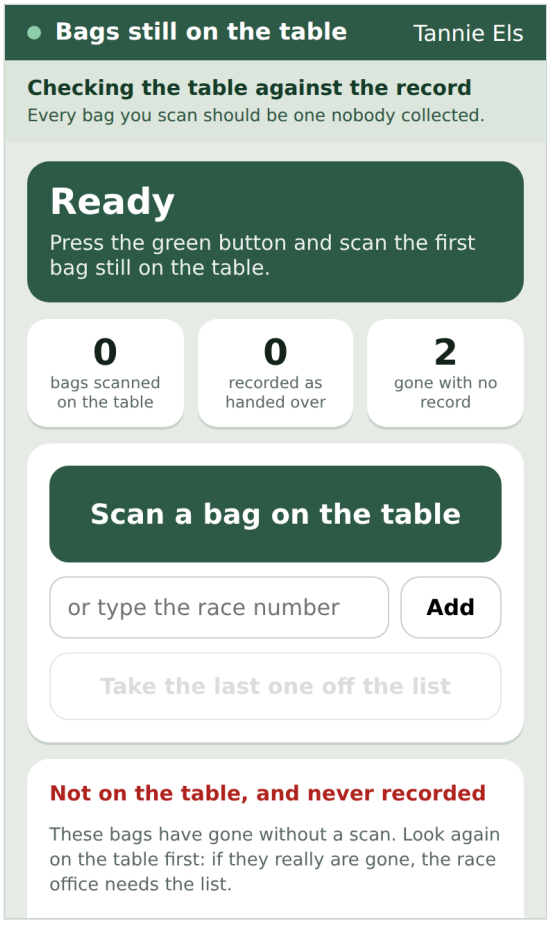


Figure 15. *Scanning working: the walk of the table at the end is an audit and changes nothing.*

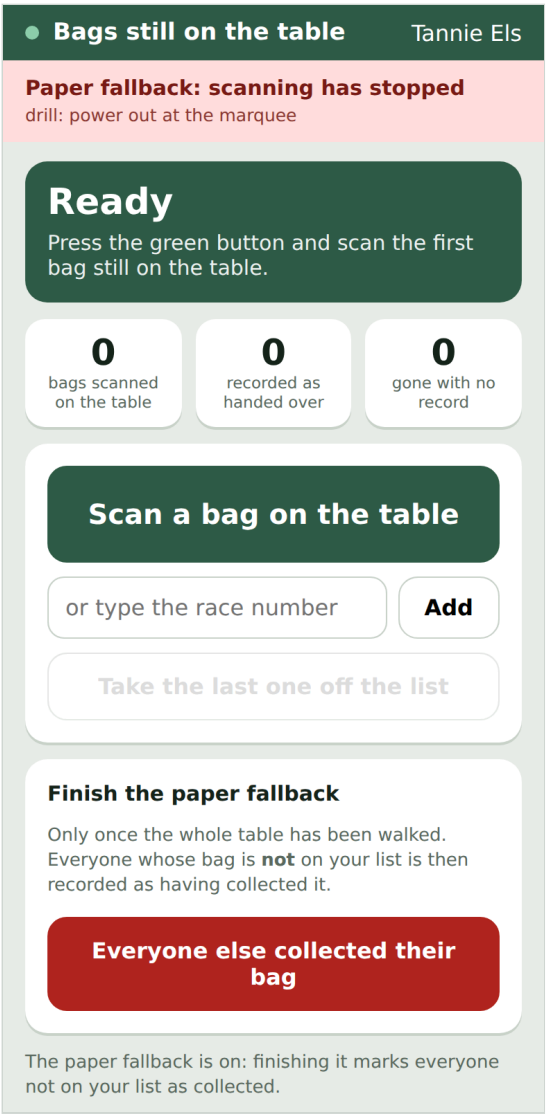


Figure 16. *Scanning declared stopped: red, and the button that records everyone else as collected appears.*

Part D: The walk of the table at the end

When the desk closes, one person walks the tables with the second app (the table-walk code), scanning every bag still on them.

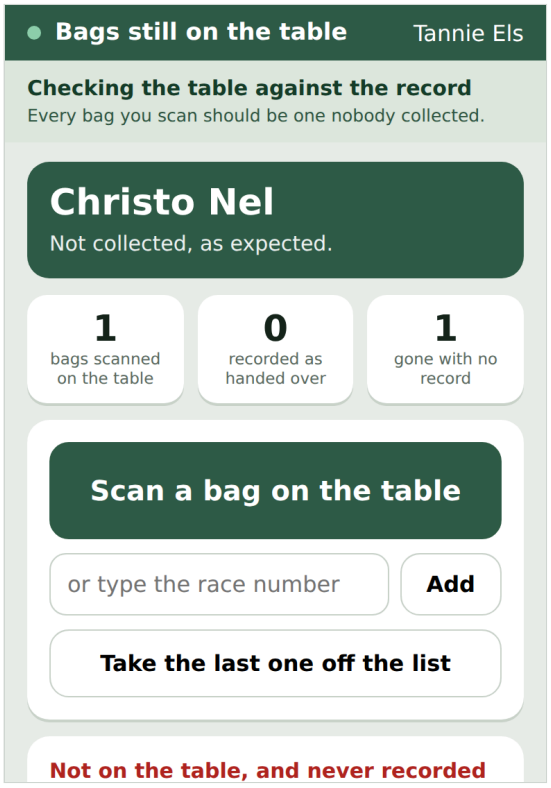


Figure 17. *A bag nobody collected: no news.*

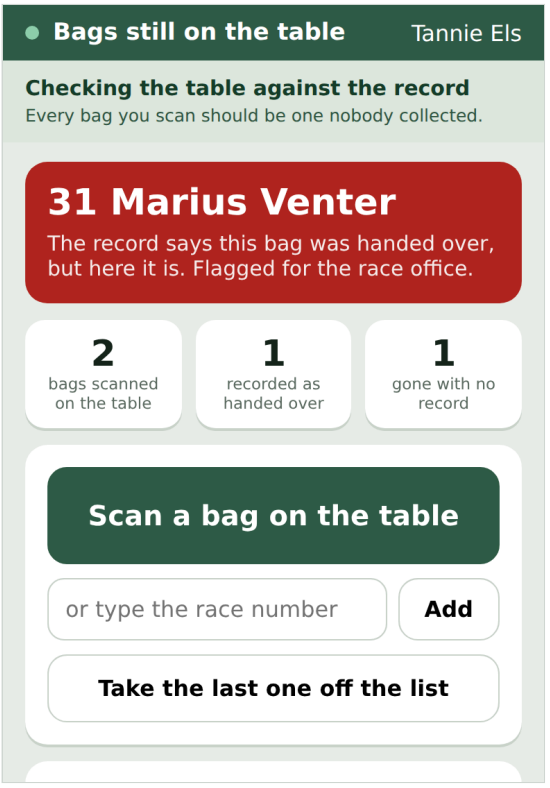


Figure 18. *A bag the record says has gone: red. Somebody brought it back, or it was never handed over. Ask, and write it down.*

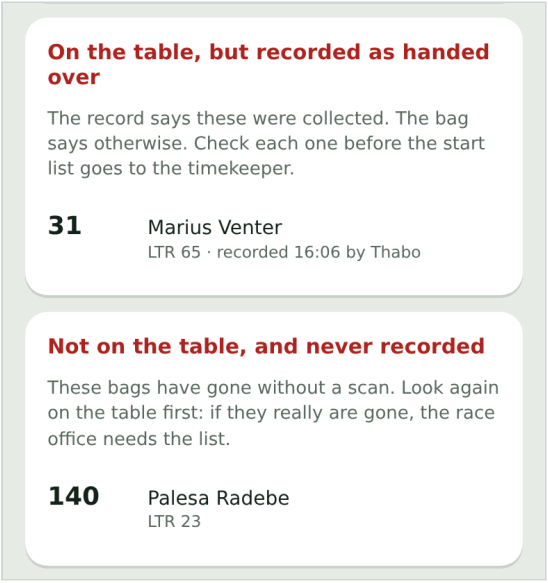


Figure 19. *At the end: bags here that the record says have gone, and bags gone that the record has never heard of. The second list is the one that finds a bag out of place, or a theft.*